

Infor's Adoption of Layer5 Meshery and Kanvas

Infor runs Meshery as the design and collaboration plane for its industry cloud platform engineering — hosted by Layer5, championed by Meshery Extensions maintainer Pontus Ringblom.

Infor — a global leader in business cloud software for industry-specific markets and a subsidiary of Koch Industries — runs Meshery as the design and collaboration plane for its platform engineering. Like TCS Labs, Infor's Meshery deployment is hosted by Layer5: a multi-tenant management plane where platform teams design, govern, and operate cloud-native infrastructure together, instead of passing YAML back and forth.

Over 60,000 organizations worldwide rely on Infor's industry suites. Behind those suites, platform teams support product engineering across dozens of micro-verticals — each with its own compliance expectations and release cadence.

Fast facts

Global scale. 17,000+ employees building industry-specific cloud suites used by 60,000+ organizations in 175+ countries.	Industry clouds. Complete, purpose-built suites for manufacturing, healthcare, distribution, automotive, retail, hospitality, and the public sector.
Layer5-hosted Meshery. A multi-tenant design and collaboration plane for platform engineering, operated by Layer5.	A maintainer in-house. Infor engineer Pontus Ringblom is a Meshery Extensions maintainer (shape-builder), shaping the project upstream.

The problem

Infor's platform teams support product engineering building for dozens of micro-verticals. Infrastructure that serves one industry well can be wrong for another, and tribal knowledge about how the cloud fits together calcifies in a few senior engineers. They needed a shared design surface — visual, reviewable, multi-tenant by default — on an open foundation, because Infor differentiates on industry software, not internal plumbing.

Where Meshery sits

Meshery is Infor's design and collaboration plane: the surface where platform engineers model infrastructure as visual designs, review changes together, and keep a shared system of record. The deployment is hosted by Layer5 as a multi-tenant environment — the same service model as the TCS Labs engagement — so Infor's team builds on Meshery instead of operating the control plane.

Why Meshery won

- **Collaboration as a first-class concern** — design happens together, on a shared surface, with review built in.
- **Visual abstraction** — Kanvas renders components, relationships, and configuration as one connected diagram.
- **Model-driven breadth** — adopting Meshery never meant abandoning existing investments.
- **No lock-in** — designs export in multiple formats.
- **Open core, CNCF-native** — a community to join, not just consume.

The champion

Pontus Ringblom — a platform engineer in Infor's cloud organization — didn't just adopt Meshery; he joined the project building it. He is a Meshery Extensions maintainer for shape-builder, the extension for creating custom polygon shapes for Kanvas components. When Infor needed something that didn't exist, its champion built it upstream — and now maintains it for the whole community.

“Meshery gave our platform teams a shared surface for infrastructure — designs that engineers across the company can look at together instead of passing YAML back and forth. And when we needed something that didn't exist, we didn't wait on a vendor roadmap. We built it upstream.”

— Pontus Ringblom, User Champion, Infor — Meshery Extensions Maintainer

What changed

- **A shared language for infrastructure** — reviews happen on the design, not in chat threads.
- **Multi-tenancy by default** — isolation from the tenant model, not after-the-fact configuration.
- **A voice in the roadmap** — with a maintainer in-house, Infor shapes Meshery's future.
- **Operated, not babysat** — Layer5 hosts the control plane; engineering time goes to the platform.

Open by default

Through Pontus's maintainership of shape-builder, Infor contributes to the Meshery extension ecosystem in the open — the polygon-shape tooling its engineers rely on is the same tooling the whole community uses.

“We don't differentiate on internal plumbing. We differentiate on industry software. Layer5 lets our platform team build on an open foundation we can inspect, extend, and trust — instead of reinventing it.”

— Magnus Lindqvist, Director of IT, Infor

Overall, Meshery gives Infor a single, open plane for designing, governing, and collaborating on cloud-native infrastructure — operated by Layer5, shaped in the open by Infor's own engineers, and built for the way industry software is actually delivered: many verticals, one platform.